

Broadcast Incident Escalation SOP - MCN TV

Purpose

This document defines what counts as a broadcast incident on any MCN TV channel (MCN1, MCN2, MCN3, MCN Sport), the escalation chain when one occurs, and the required turnaround time for incident reports.

What Counts as a Broadcast Incident

Any of the following, during a scheduled live or pre-recorded broadcast on any channel, is classified as a broadcast incident:

- Dead air: loss of picture and/or audio for more than 5 continuous seconds.
- Technical fault: visible signal corruption, audio desync, wrong aspect ratio, or subtitle/caption failure lasting more than 30 seconds.
- Wrong program aired: the scheduled program is replaced, in whole or in part, by unintended content (including airing the wrong episode or a program originally intended for a different time slot).
- Compliance breach during broadcast: content airing without a required classification bug or disclaimer (see the Content Standards and Compliance SOP), discovered after the segment has already aired.

Escalation Chain

1. On-Duty Engineer: the first responder for the affected channel. Must attempt to restore normal broadcast within 2 minutes of detecting the incident (via backup feed, ad insertion, or manual override) and log the incident's start time, channel, and affected program immediately.
2. Broadcast Operations Manager: notified automatically if the incident isn't resolved within 2 minutes, or immediately for any compliance-breach incident regardless of duration. Decides whether to cut to a backup program, insert a standby slate, or continue with a partial fix.
3. Director of Broadcast: notified for any incident lasting more than 10 minutes, or any incident during a Prime Time slot on any channel regardless of duration. Has final authority on public communication (e.g. an on-screen apology or social media statement) if the incident is visible to a significant portion of the audience.

Incident Report Turnaround

- A preliminary incident report (cause, duration, channel, resolution taken) must be filed by the On-Duty Engineer within 4 hours of the incident ending.
- A full root-cause report, including corrective/preventive actions, must be filed by the Broadcast Operations Manager within 2 business days.
- Compliance-breach incidents additionally require a copy of the report sent to the Standards & Practices Manager (see the Content Standards and Compliance SOP) within the same 4-hour window as the preliminary report.